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From: <lora@plantsandherbals.org>

Date: Monday, August 3, 2026

Subject: Kratom Information - Helpful for your presentation on August 11

To: "[Lora](mailto:lora@plantsandherbals.org)" <lora@plantsandherbals.org>

Cc: "Dr. Heidi Sykora"

<drheidisykora@plantsandherbals.org>



Hi there! I am reaching out to you since I noticed that you will be presenting a Zoom presentation on kratom on August 11. I am offering some resources that will be very helpful for to you. Especially since you work in schools with children and teens. It is incredibly important that the correct information is circulated so that citizens and parents are accurately understanding the issue. Remember, natural leaf kratom is just that...natural leaf. Synthetic products are lab created and far from natural leaf. Synthetic products are not natural kratom.

[Kratom Regulatory Briefing](#)

[Understanding Kratom: A Caregivers Guide](#)

By way of introduction, my name is Lora Romney. I am a 9-year daily kratom consumer who uses natural leaf kratom to manage severe chronic facial pain (Trigeminal Neuralgia). Kratom has been a critical part of my health journey. Honestly, it's been life changing. I can now work, volunteer, take care of my grandchildren and thrive again because I am not bedridden in severe pain. I am now a kratom advocate, educator, and the president of the International Plant & Herbal Alliance (www.plantsandherbals.org). This issue is personal to me. I am not alone. There are many just like me who have found natural leaf kratom to be an incredibly helpful health and wellness tool. A local ban on natural leaf kratom could hurt kratom consumers in pain, those with

anxiety, and others that use kratom as a harm reduction tool, so IPHA works hard to educate communities about this important issue.

I am not sure if you are aware that the DEA will be scheduling synthetic derivatives on August 6. Not natural leaf. This will be a groundbreaking day because synthetic products definitely need to be removed from store shelves.

"These actions are not intended to regulate natural leaf kratom that does not contain enhanced levels of 7-OH. Although 7-OH occurs naturally in trace amounts in the kratom plant, scheduling 7-OH above a certain threshold level does not intend to capture the kratom botanical leaf in the present temporary scheduling recommendation. MP, MGM-15 and MGM-16 do not occur naturally in the plant. MP is a chemical rearrangement product of 7-OH, while MGM-15 and MGM-16 are synthetic derivatives of 7-OH." **HHS press release regarding DEA announcement on July 6, 2026.**

Now is the perfect time for cities to pass ordinances that push for good regulation on natural leaf kratom. This will ensure that only tested, properly labeled and age-gated product is sold.

The Kratom Consumer Protection Act (state and local) has the following requirements:

1. Age restriction – 21+
2. Strict GMP regulations for safe packaging and distribution.

3. Appropriate labeling based on requirements for dietary supplements: ingredients, serving size, warnings, etc. (I suggest adding language that prohibits packaging and marketing that is appealing to minors.)
4. Language that restricts the amount of 7-hydroxymitragynine (or other synthetic kratom derivatives) allowed in the product. In natural plant kratom, the levels of 7-OH are less than 2% of the overall alkaloids (or 1 mg/serving). This requirement prohibits 7-OH and other synthetics from being sold. This language mirrors the DEA's scheduling requirement.

As kratom educators, Dr. Sykora and I would love to work with you in the future. We are happy to answer any questions about kratom, the science & policy, and share our personal perspectives as consumers (pain patients). Please reach out! I will be tuning into the Zoom.

Lora Romney

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Heidi Sykora, DNP

Doctor of Nursing Practice | Retired Nurse Practitioner | Healthcare Executive



I am a retired Nurse Practitioner and healthcare executive with more than three decades of experience leading clinical innovation and patient-centered care. In addition to treating and prescribing for medically fragile patients, I directed multihospital oncology programs, opened the region's only post-acute brain injury unit, and received the Milwaukee BizTimes Healthcare Hero Award for visionary leadership. I have taught at the graduate level and held advanced certifications in geriatrics, oncology, and brain injury.

I serve as Volunteer Chief Scientific Officer for the International Plant and Herbal Alliance (IPHA), a 501(c)(3) nonprofit focused on science-based public education about botanical products. I have no financial ties to the kratom industry.

My work with IPHA centers on scientific education for policymakers, clinicians, and the public. This includes explaining the scientific distinction between natural kratom leaf and semisynthetic concentrated 7-hydroxymitragynine products, as well as regulatory frameworks such as the Kratom Consumer Protection Act (KCPA), which establishes product testing, accurate labeling, and age-restriction standards.

I also conduct independent scientific reviews of publicly available medical examiner and toxicology records in kratom-associated cases. In June 2026, I presented this work at a Congressional Briefing alongside Dr. Rahul Gupta, former Director of the Office of National Drug Control Policy, and Dr. Jack Henningfield of Johns Hopkins University.

I share my personal health experience in my individual capacity; it does not represent a clinical recommendation by IPHA. I live with multiple rare and painful conditions, including Chiari Malformation, Tethered Spinal Cord, Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome, Hereditary Alpha Tryptasemia, and Thoracic Outlet Syndrome. After exhausting pharmaceutical options, I found natural leaf kratom to be the most effective and tolerable option for my own care, and I have used it as needed for more than seven years.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

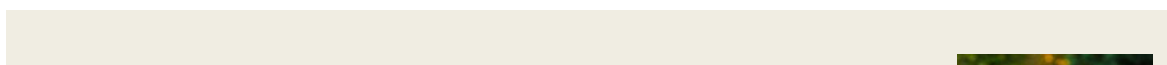
- *Home Care and the Patient Taking Kratom*. Home Healthcare Now, 2025. PubMed PMID: 40019266
- *Kratom: A Nurse Practitioner's Perspective on Patient-Centered Regulation*. KevinMD, 2024.

CONTACT

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This biography is provided for educational purposes and does not constitute medical advice. Personal health experience is shared in the author's individual capacity.



Lora Smith Romney

President, International Plant and Herbal Alliance | Accountant | Plant Medicine Advocate



I am an accountant with more than three decades of professional experience, having served as controller for several real estate development companies in Utah. I hold a BS in Accounting from Weber State University and have a passion for music, volunteering, and numbers.

I serve as President of the International Plant and Herbal Alliance (IPHA), a Utah 501(c)(3) nonprofit focused on science-based public education about botanical products.

My path to plant medicine advocacy began with my own search for relief. Before joining IPHA, I served for two years as treasurer of TRUCE (Together for Responsible Use and Cannabis Education), an effort that contributed to medical cannabis becoming legal in Utah in 2018. In 2019, I testified before the Utah legislature during hearings on the Kratom Consumer Protection Act (KCPA), which establishes product testing, accurate labeling, and age-restriction standards, and I was invited to be present when Governor Herbert signed the KCPA into law. Since then, I have helped hundreds of people learn about kratom and responsible botanical use.

I share my personal health experience in my individual capacity; it does not represent a clinical recommendation by IPHA. I have lived with Atypical Trigeminal Neuralgia, a condition of constant and severe facial nerve pain, for more than 14 years. Over that time I tried more than 25 pharmaceuticals, Botox, nerve blocks, a stimulator implant in my face, and brain surgery to release the nerve. All of these treatments failed, and due to opioid restrictions I was prescribed an inadequate dose of pain medication. Although medical cannabis helps many people, it did not control my pain. In 2017, a trusted friend with the same condition told me about kratom. I found that natural leaf kratom helped my pain without altering me in any way, with no foggy head and no high, and I was able to transition off opioids. It has remained the most effective and tolerable option for my daily care.

PERSONAL

I am a mother of four and, most recently, a first-time grandma. I serve as treasurer of Harmonic Winds of Utah, where I play the flute, and I enjoy reading, bowling, camping, and walking my dog.

CONTACT

Lora Romney

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Natural Kratom Leaf Products Versus Synthetic Alkaloids

This is **KRATOM**: Natural Leaf Kratom Products

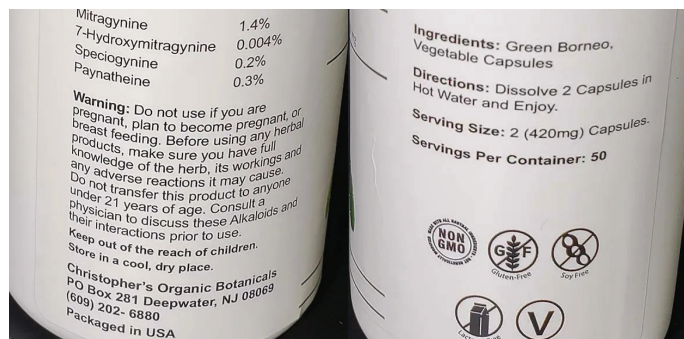


Powder with batch tested alkaloid levels.
Properly labeled with warning and directions for use.

Extract with batch tested alkaloid levels and directions for use.

Powdered Capsules
100% Pure
Mitragyna Speciosa
Properly labeled,
warning and
directions for use.

Batch tested
alkaloid levels.



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